Session 2 of 2

Channels, growth & the *next hundred*.

What you'll learn

- Channels
- Growth systems
- Funnel & metrics

Bridge from S1

Channels don't *fix* weak positioning.

What Session 1 gave you, and the one precondition before any channel is worth scaling.

You should now have

- ☐ A positioning brief a stranger can quote back
- ☐ A named beachhead - with a score
- ☐ An ICP one-pager, finished
- ☐ 25 named targets - 10 warm, 10 lukewarm, 5 cold
- ☐ A motion pick you can defend on one slide
- ☐ Retention data showing ≥ 25% D30

Precondition

A channel is a *force multiplier*.

Multipliers amplify whatever they multiply - **zero retention equals zero growth, at any spend.**

Five criteria before the matrix

Channels aren’t equal. *Score on five aspects*.

A channel that dominates one criterion still fails unless the other four don’t break.

01 · Reach

who

Can you reach the named ICP, not abstract “users”?

02 · Cost

how much

CAC

03 · Velocity

how fast

Days from launch to first signal - not months.

04 · CAC quality

what kind

Repeat user / Referrer / Power user

05 · Compounding

Gets better over time

Each dollar spent makes the next dollar work harder.

The math behind the matrix

Score 0–3 on each. Don’t weight by how cool the channel is. ***Two channels scoring 12/15 matters more than five at 9.***

Anti-patterns

Do not score SEO the same as a podcast guest spot and call it 3 channels of marketing - it is one bet.

Do not chase the channel that worked for someone else, in another market at another scale.

Do not add channels to fix the one that isn’t working.

The 16-channel matrix · 1 of 2 (The "restaurant with 16 doors")

Earned & relational channels - *channels 1 – 8*.

Scores are illustrative - tune them to your stage, market and motion. They are not absolutes.

Channel	Reach	Cost	Velocity	Quality	Compounding	Total
Warm intros & referrals	1	3	2	3	2	11 / 15
Cold email outbound	3	3	3	2	0	11 / 15
LinkedIn outbound	2	3	3	2	0	10 / 15
Word-of-mouth / viral	2	3	1	3	3	12 / 15
Double-sided referrals	2	3	2	3	3	13 / 15
Content inbound (blog/newsletter)	3	3	0	3	3	12 / 15
SEO (technical & topical)	3	2	0	3	3	11 / 15
Community (Slack/Discord)	1	2	2	3	3	11 / 15

Legend

Scores 0–3 across reach, cost, velocity, quality and compounding. Tinted row edge is the channel's strongest dimension.

The 16-channel matrix · 2 of 2

Paid, scaled & product-led - *channels 9 – 16*.

Channel	Reach	Cost	Velocity	Quality	Compounding	Total
Paid search (SEM)	3	0	3	2	0	8 / 15
Paid social	3	1	3	1	0	8 / 15
Influencer (< 100K followers)	2	2	2	2	1	9 / 15
Influencer (macro 500K+)	3	0	1	1	0	5 / 15
Events (IRL + online)	1	2	0	3	2	8 / 15
PR & earned media	3	3	0	3	2	11 / 15
Partnerships & integrations	2	3	0	3	3	11 / 15
PLG & self-serve freemium	3	3	2	3	3	14 / 15

Top score (paid/scaled)

PLG & self-serve

14 / 15

Avoid at < $1M ARR

Macro influencers

5 / 15

Median across 8

9.5 / 15

most fail Velocity

Combine across matrix

Pick 2–3 at most

and measure all five

From matrix to plan

Score your own channels - *and force trade-offs*.

Step 1

Pick 6–8 plausible.

Pre-filter with motion + stage. If you have no warm intros as a B2B seller, exclude that one. If you have no in-house writer, exclude SEO.

Step 2

Score 0–3 each.

No anchors, no rounding, no “2.5.” If you can’t commit, force rank. Scores < 9 go on the “parked” pile.

Step 3

Pick 2–3 at most.

Commit. Park the rest for 90 days. Channels > 3 mean no channel is run well.

Worked · B2B SaaS at seed

Commit · owner: founder

Warm intros · 13 / 15

3 intros / week, 25% close

Commit · owner: founder + SDR

Cold email · 11 / 15

10K sends / mo, 1.5% reply

Park · 90-day review

SEO · 11, Influencer · 9, Events · 8

No owner this quarter

Why ≤ 3 channels at a time

Each channel needs an owner, a measurement plan and monthly review. Past three, attention fragments - and “we’re doing all of them” turns into “we’re doing none of them.”

Channel deep-dive · 1

Warm & cold outbound - *the dialing channel*.

The two most-used channels at seed. The difference between them is who makes the first move.

Warm outbound

A second-degree *warm* signal arrives.

Conversion · > 25% reply · 15–30% close

vs < 2% on cold

CAC · Low

Often zero cash cost - founder time

Velocity · days, not weeks

5 intros per week, 1.2 close in week 3

Pitfall

Network dries out by month 4. Refill with newer, outer-circle contacts.

Cold outbound

You *send first*.

Conversion · 1–3% reply · 0.3–1% close

Without personalization - half of that

CAC · Medium

Tooling + SDR + lists add up fast

Velocity · 7–21 days to first signal

Test 4–8 weeks before judging

Pitfall

Volume arms race - blasting, then deliverability collapse.

Run order

Warm first - learn what your buyer sounds like. Cold second - scale what warm proved. Reverse them and you're guessing.

Channel deep-dive · 2

Content + SEO - *the only true compounding*.

Each piece of content can work for years - but the first 90 days are brutal. Treated as a media buy, it fails.

Math that matters

$<0.50 / *visit*

After 12+ months. Months 1–6 cost more than they bring.

Time to first signal

4–8 *months*

Even at 2 posts/week, ranking takes compounding & patience.

What makes it work

Match query to aha

Not keyword to topic.

Most articles miss because they answer a question readers never finished asking.

A 90-day posting plan for a 3-person team

Month 1

Pillar + 4 spin-offs.

Pick the question your buyer asks ten times a week. Write the definitive answer.

Month 2

Distribute + measure.

Repurpose into 12 short forms. Track scroll-depth, time-on-page, opt-ins.

Month 3

Topical cluster + interlinks.

Add 6 supporting pieces nearby. Build the moat on one cluster, not random posts.

Reference · **Zerodha ran nearly zero paid spend. Content, education and community compound-built a multi-lakh-crore brokerage - a content engine, not a campaign.**

Channel deep-dive · 3

Referrals, app stores & PLG - *the user-as-marketer*.

Referrals

1... becomes 2...

Ask at the moment of aha. Ask once - twice at most.

Dropbox famous number

+60% CAC cut · +35% signups

Trigger

aha moment, not sign-up

Double-sided rewards beat single-sided - but cap them or margins collapse.

App stores

Discovery, not acquisition.

Two surfaces - search & featured. Both must be earned.

Retention, ratings, velocity

Cost

Apple 15% · Google 15%

Localize titles, screenshots, descriptions - India is not the US.

PLG · product-led growth

Product does the selling.

Useful on day one, valuable on day 30 - or the gate fails.

10K messages reached the wall

activation → habit → gate

Free is the message - free that doesn't work advertises wrong.

Use them together

PLG is your funnel. App stores are discovery on top. Referrals extend the loop. None replaces the others - and none compensates for weak positioning.

References · Dropbox case study (SaaSquatch/Sean Ellis), Slack 0→8M DAU with 10K-message paywall (First Round review).

Channel deep-dive · 4

Partnerships & PR - *borrowed credibility*.

Three partnership types

Borrow someone *else's audience*.

Type A · integrations

Sit inside a tool your buyer already opens every day. Best when free + co-marketed.

Type B · co-marketing

Joint webinars, case studies, content. Both audiences attend - usually one half is the prize.

Type C · distribution

Resellers, agencies, OEM. Slow to set up, fastest to scale once traction lands.

Three PR frames

Become a *named* thing.

Frame 1 · contrarian data

Survey 50 of your users, surface a counterintuitive stat. Pitch it once a quarter.

Frame 2 · founder POV

Not "company news" - the founder's named opinion, twice a month.

Frame 3 · customer in story

Trade anonymity for narrative. Pick the story, not the logo.

Why they pair well

PR without partnerships reads like an announcement. Partnerships without PR reads like spam. Each is the amplifier of the other.

B2C-specific

B2C channels - *scale, but with conscience*.

The buyer is one person and decides in seconds. Channels must catch them, not chase them.

Performance ads

Fast & expensive

Meta, Google, programmatic. Buy attention in 50ms auctions.

Beware attribution drift.

Influencer · micro

Underrated, costly

Trust transfer beats reach. Especially in regional languages.

See follow-up slide.

Organic social

Slow & sticky

Reels, Shorts, X. Brand voice in public. Compounds when consistent.

Pick a lane; don't splatter.

Marketplaces

Borrow, then own

Amazon, Flipkart, Nykaa. Useful while direct lags. Don't stay forever.

Data captured, then port.

Three B2C caveats

Language > language

Hindi or Tamil is not "English in different words". Trust registers first.

Repeat > reach

50K monthly active beats 5M impressions. Optimise for purchase #3.

Distribution > acquisition

In India, offline footprint often helps - shelf, retailer, storefronts, kirana reach for D2C.

Reference · Nykaa

Started as a pure beauty marketplace, layered owned content and stores, eventually built private label.

Marketplace seeded knowledge; brand & stores captured margin.

Don't

Run five B2C channels at once with one manager. Each needs a number, a budget, an owner and a monthly cohort review.

Influencer · the truth

Micro *almost always* beats macro.

Reach is the cheapest thing to buy. Trust isn't. Below 100K followers you usually get trust; above 500K you're buying reach that converts worse.

Micro · 5K–100K followers

Trust *at the cost of reach*.

Engagement rate · 4–8%
Comments feel personal; replies feel personal.

Cost · $50–$2,000 per post
Often barter + small fee at sub-20K.

Content control · low; the more, the better
Their voice carries - negotiate themes, not scripts.

Use case · categories, niches, regional
Coffee reviewer in Bangalore > Bollywood star for a BPC launch.

Macro · 500K+ followers

Reach *at the cost of trust*.

Engagement rate · 0.5–2%
Likes are real, conversions rarely are.

Cost · $5K–$300K per post
Often misses sub-1M in CAC quality.

Content control · medium; brief required
Approval cycles in days, not weeks.

Use case · awareness, category creation
Only useful when reach itself is the asset.

Three rules · how to actually pick

Buy 10 micros before 1 macro
Unless your budget for awareness alone is > $200K. The variance per post is also smaller.

Code every conversion
Unique links + UTMs by creator. Cheaper creators, better data, fast iteration.

Pay for outcomes, not posts
CPM is a vanity. CPA, retention and repeat lift are the real fixes.

Engineering virality

K-factor & content engines - *growth as a system*.

Anatomy

K = invites/user × conversion

Lever A · invites/user

2.5

Top of buyer journey

Lever B · conversion

20%

Quality of invite UX

Below K = 1, growth requires linear effort. Above K = 1, every user begets more users. Aim: **K > 1 by month 6.**

Four engines that drive the loop

- **User-to-user invites**
  Best asked at the aha moment - not sign-up.
- **Built-in sharing surfaces**
  Public dashboards, shareable links, “made with.”
- **Network-required features**
  Multiplayer by default - one user pulls teammates.
- **Cross-product integrations**
  A pull from another tool, by a real user.

Most products ship one engine and call it growth. Two engines > one engine, always.

Why most “viral loops” fail silently

1. **No moment of aha captured**
   Share triggers fire too early.
2. **Invite UX is broken**
   Forms, walls, friction before the value.
3. **Reward structure misaligned**
   Refers the wrong users or too few.

The fastest way to burn money

Paid acquisition - *don't pour into a leaky bucket*.



Spend in
expensive daily, slow to feel

Leaks out
churn, poor onboarding, wrong ICP

Net
smaller than the spend every month

Three numbers to know

< 25%
D30 retention
Paid spend before this is a loan against your future.

3 : 1
LTV-to-CAC floor
Below this, scale refuses to ship without raising.

< 18 months
CAC payback ceiling
Aim < 12 months at top-tier; cap at 18.

What "closing the leak" looks like

1. **Cut low-LTV cohorts**
   Stop bidding on bad keywords.
2. **Fix first-week onboarding**
   Most leak is week 1.
3. **Re-bid by quality**
   Pay less for converters, more for retainers.
4. **Re-target survivors**
   12+ months repeat, not sign-up.

Only when the bucket holds should you turn up the spend. The math, not the marketing team, decides when.

Math behind the dashboard

CAC, LTV & payback - *the three you must know*.

CAC

CAC = *spend* / new buyers

Include every fully-loaded cost - tools, sales time, agency, content production, referral payouts.

LTV

LTV = ARPU × gross margin × 1 / churn

Cap at 5 years. Don't show "infinite LTV" projections to investors.

Payback

Months until CAC recovered

Gross-margin-adjusted. Tells you how fast growth spends recoup.

Worked · B2B SaaS example

ARPU / yr	Gross margin	Annual churn	CAC
$1,200	75%	20%	$1,500

Result

LTV = $1,200 × 0.75 / 0.20 = $4,500

LTV : CAC = 3 : 1 · Payback = 20 months

3 : 1 puts the company in healthy B2B SaaS territory. 5 : 1 may mean you're under-investing. Below 2 : 1, scale refuses to deliver margin.

Reference points

3 : 1 healthy · 3.2 : 1 current B2B median · payback < 18 months good, < 12 months top-tier (OpenView, SaaSHero, Benchmarkit, 2024–26).

Setting the bar

Payback benchmark - *where your model sits*.

LTV : CAC ratio ↑

	< 12 mo	12–18 mo	18–36 mo
3–5	**Scale hard** You're under-investing in growth.	**Healthy** Fundable, scale deliberately.	**Watch churn** margins thin.
1–3	**Healthy** Fundable; protect cash.	**Mediocre** Survivable, not a category leader.	**Bleeding** Stop scaling spend. Fix retention.
< 1	**Bleeding** Don't raise. Reset economics.	**Red flag** Don't raise. Reset economics.	**Exit** Don't spend. Don't pretend.

Payback period →

How to read it

Most seed-stage startups sit in the middle or worse - **fix the model before computing on it**.

If you're > 5 : 1

Could spend 2x more - or you don't need to, in which case grow moats, not ads.

1–3 : 1 + slow payback

Enterprise ACV or land-and-expand. May survive, hard to fund for scale.

< 1 anywhere

Shutdown territory. Reframe or shut.

How credit gets assigned

Four attribution models - *and the lie they all tell*.

Attribution isn't truth - it's a choice of which lie you can defend. Pick one, defend it, and use the rest as triangulation.

Last touch

100% credit to final channel

Easy. Cheap. Over-states branded search and direct. **Use only at first contact.**

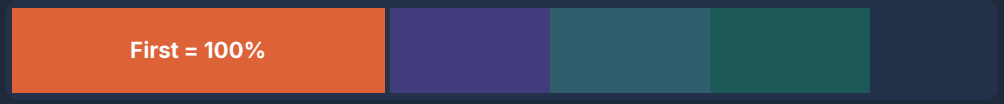


A · B · C · D · **E (final)**

First touch

100% credit to first channel

Useful in PLG and viral loops. **Over-states noisy discovery - ignores nurturing.**

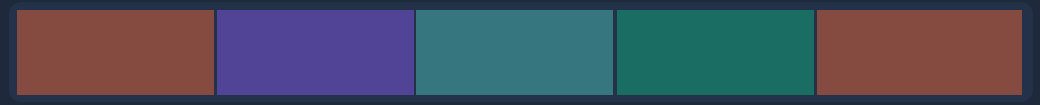


A (first) · B · C · D · E

Linear

Equal credit across touches

Defensible default for B2B cycles. **Wastes credit on low-impact touches.**

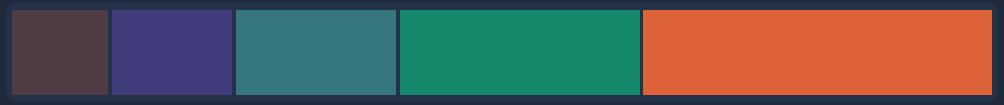


A · B · C · D · E - equal slices

Time-decay

Closer touches get more credit

Best when nurture runs in the middle. Common for SaaS sales cycles > 30 days.



A tiny · B · C · D · **E largest**

What to actually install

A practical measurement *stack*.

Three layers - events on the bottom, decisions on top. Spend less on tooling than you do on the questions you ask.

Layer 3 · decisions

Where you actually decide what to do next.

Weekly review
10 metrics, no more.

Live dashboard
Cohort + channel visible.

Owner + 1 number
Every metric has accountability.

Layer 2 · cohort & LTV math

What survives - by channel, by cohort, by month.

Cohort retention table
By acquisition channel.

LTV by cohort
Cap at 24–36 mo for early reads.

CAC by channel
Refunds & gross-margin-adjusted.

Layer 1 · events & identity

What actually happened - cleanly.

Product analytics
Amplitude / Mixpanel / PostHog

Server events
Server-side, deduplicated

UTM & referrer
Campaigns named consistently

Identity stitching
Anonymous↔named user map

Conversion rate optimisation

The funnel has *four levers*, not thirty.

01 · visit

Landing page reaches them — 100%

02 · activate

Aha moment is reached — ~40%

03 · convert

They pay (or commit) — ~8%

04 · expand

They buy again or upgrade — ~3%

Four levers to push

Reach a better visitor

Higher intent > more clever copy.

Compress time-to-aha

Fewer steps, fewer sign-ups required.

Lower first-commit friction

Trial > demo > founder call - in that order, sometimes.

Engineer the second purchase

Triggers, lifecycle nudges, upsell at usage moments.

A useful rule

Doubling conversion at any stage doubles revenue at that stage. Doubling traffic, *doubles your burn*.

Fix the funnel before the channel. Otherwise you're just paying more to lose more.

Worked example · seed-stage SaaS

A funnel fix that *doubled paid conversion*.

Before

10,000 visits

→ 80 paid

Visit → trial
15%: 6-step form, no preview

Trial → paid
5%: paywall at day 14, generic

Total funnel
~0.8% conversion · 80 paid / 10K visits

CAC $625 · payback 22 months

After

10,000 visits

→ 168 paid

Visit → trial
22%: 1 email + interactive demo

Trial → paid
7.5%: paywall at usage moment

Total funnel
~1.7% conversion · 168 paid / 10K visits

CAC $295 · payback 13 months

What changed

1. Cut 6-step form to 1 email
Trial conversion 15% → 22%.

2. Paywall at usage moment
Triggered from a usage event, not a date.

3. Personalised upgrade nudge
Messaging tied to the user's last action.

Picking what to try

ICE - *simple, decent, honest*.

Impact · Confidence · Ease. Score 1–10 on each. Multiply (or add) and rank your experiments. Don’t be precious.

Impact

Will it *move the number*?

Don’t score “imagined” impact. Score the change you would actually see.

Confidence

How *sure* are you?

Past data, customer pull, prior tests - not vibe. Lower confidence = bigger test budget needed.

Ease

Cost to ship, cost to *measure*.

Cheap ideas that move 5% are still better than costly 30% guesses.

How to score

I × C × E = score · max 1,000

Or add them. Pick a convention and stick. Re-scored every two weeks - scores move when evidence does.

Honest, not optimistic
You score; a colleague reviews.

No ties
Tie-break on Impact or rewrite ties.

Ship the top 3
Only top 3. The rest - next sprint.

Five experiments scored

Five experiments, scored - *two ship, three wait*.

Experiment	Impact	Confidence	Ease	Score	Decision
Trigger-based paywall at usage moment Replaces blanket day-14 paywall.	9	8	7	504	Ship
Founder-led closed beta with 20 ICP users 30 days, weekly demos.	9	7	8	504	Ship
SEO pillar piece on category creation Long horizon; compounding, slow.	8	4	3	96	Wait
Brand-led Super Bowl-style awareness push High spend, low fit at seed.	7	2	1	14	Wait
App-store launch with paid install campaigns Wrong fit if B2B.	6	5	5	150	Park

Reading the table

Two ideas shipped. Both are low-medium ease and high impact - typical “always ship” entries. The high-impact, low-confidence SEO idea gets parked, not killed - revisit in Q3.

Rescore bi-weekly

Parked ≠ killed

Top 3, no more

When founder-led stops scaling

The founder sale - *know when to leave*.

Founder sales close faster, smarter, and pick up the phone on a Saturday. None of those scale. There's a moment to leave - and it's earlier than you think.

0–$1M ARR

Founder-led, mostly

Founder closes every deal. Useful signal. Earns playbooks.

- Every call logged; reasons logged; objections logged.
- Aim: 50 closed deals. Write the playbook.
- Time spent: 60–80% of founder hours.

Exit signal

When another rep closes a deal at the same win rate using your notes.

$1–$5M ARR

First hires carry it

Hire 2 AEs + 1 SDR. Founder shadows first 30 deals, then steps back.

- AE handles deals < $30K ACV. Founder takes strategic.
- Founder time drops to 30%. Product & strategy absorb the rest.
- Weekly pipeline review, written.

Exit signal

Pipeline value > quarterly target; founder only reviews exceptions.

$5M+ ARR

Process carries it

Manager + comp plans + playbook updates. Founder is the last 5%.

- Reps ramp in 90 days, not 180.
- Comp plan with accelerators, not caps.
- Forecast is reviewed, not felt.

Exit signal

Founder joins only on logos > 5% of book.

Cost of staying too long

The founder becomes the bottleneck, the playbook never gets tested, hires never get reps. Worse - the founder also becomes the brand, so customers stay founder-dependent.

Hire your replacement before you need them.

Order matters

The first five GTM hires - in the order you actually need them.

Hire 01

Founding AE

Closes < $30K ACV. Builds playbook alongside founder.

Hire 02

SDR / outbound

Books meetings; named-ICP targeting; UTM-clean.

Hire 03

Content lead

Owns the editorial calendar. Distribution too.

Hire 04

Customer success

Owns retention numbers; instruments aha moment.

Hire 05

Growth PM

Funnel experiments; data plumbing; CRO.

Why this order

AEs close deals. SDRs fill pipelines. Content compounds. CS protects the bucket. Growth PM narrows the funnel. Adding a marketer before a working close-rate reads expensive.

Don't hire first

- VP Sales before ACV is clear
- Performance marketer before retention clears 25%
- Marketing Ops before product analytics
- Brand director at seed

Cost-of-hire sanity check

First 5 burn ~$1.5M / yr loaded. Make sure each hire has one number to defend weekly.

Not all moats are in the product

Five GTM moats - *how GTM itself compounds*.

Moat 1 · data network

Each user makes the next *user better*.

Waze, network-effect social, multi-tenant analytics.

Moat 2 · workflow lock-in

Daily motion you can't *easily displace*.

Email, design tools, accounting, ops dashboards.

Moat 3 · trust

Brand + reputation built over years.

Bloomberg, Sequoia, VCs.

Moat 4 · distribution

Locations & channels others can't *reach*.

Kirana networks, retail shelves, OEM contracts.

Moat 5 · expertise capital

Knowledge buyers *only you have*.

Vertical playbooks, niche research, original benchmarks.

Sixth form?

Most teams can't name one. Most should pick three to deepen.

A common question

"Don't moats come from product?" Sometimes. But three of the five moats above have nothing to do with code - and they're often the ones that decide survival.

Honest self-assessment

Which moats can *you actually build*?

Pick the moat your stage allows - then double down. Trying to build five at once builds none.

Pre-PMF · the trust moat

Build brand-of-one with 30 references.

Trust is the only moat you can credibly start here - through founder availability, not ad spend.

Early growth · the workflow moat

Embed into one daily motion.

Become the page buyers open every Monday. Switching costs rise with usage.

Scale · the network effect

Add network value to the workflow.

Make the user a contributor - or their data a public signal.

Mature · the distribution moat

Lock up locations, channels, partners.

By Series B+ the costs here are real - and competitors find them hard to copy.

Reference · Freshworks

founded Chennai 2010 · NASDAQ 2021 · ~$596M ARR by Apr 2024 - moat built on SMB workflow lock-in & integration depth across HR/helpdesk/IT.

The minimum dashboard

Ten numbers - that you actually open every Monday.

Anything more and you stop reading the dashboard. Anything less and you're steering blind.

Acquisition **CAC** trailing 30	LTV **LTV** 24-mo cohort	Payback **Months** trailing 90	Activation **D7 aha** % of new	Retention **D30** cohort
Retention **D90** cohort	Revenue **MRR** weekly	Revenue **Net new** % of book	Pipeline **Coverage** opp vs target	Viral **K** trailing 30

Four rules

1. **One number per role**
   Owners, not observers.
2. **Trends, not snapshots**
   Show 8 weeks minimum.
3. **Compare cohorts, not periods**
   Sep vs Jun is louder than Sep vs Aug.
4. **Lead with the lie detector**
   D30 retention, always.

Dashboards that look like a stock ticker are vanity. Dashboards that drive one decision per week win.

The plan, not the wish

A 90-day plan - *not a wish, a calendar*.

Days 1–30 · foundation

Prove the loop.

- **A** **Lock positioning & ICP**
  No channel decision before this.
- **B** **Ship one channel, one motion**
  Pick the highest-scoring. Commit.
- **C** **Close first 25 customers**
  Founder-led; notes logged.
- **D** **Measure baseline**
  CAC, D30, payback. No baselines yet.

Outcome target

Repeatable unit; one channel open.

Days 31–60 · optimise

Tighten before scaling.

- **E** **Fix retention gaps**
  Onboarding, aha, week-1 hook.
- **F** **Add second channel**
  Only after retention clears.
- **G** **Hire first two reps**
  AE + SDR or content lead.
- **H** **First cohort review**
  Retention table by channel.

Outcome target

Channels > 30% CAC drop.

Days 61–90 · scale

Open spend, governance.

- **I** **Scale what works**
  Spend 2x where retention holds.
- **J** **Add 3rd channel**
  With owner + measurement.
- **K** **Stand up the dashboard**
  Ten numbers; one owner each.
- **L** **First quarterly review**
  Stop, scale, or pivot.

Outcome target

Two-month runway achieved.

A 90-day plan is calibrated weekly

Re-score ICE every two weeks. Re-rank channels at the end of each 30. Don't let the plan run on autopilot - it drifts.

Module 7 · framework map

The whole module on *one canvas*.

01 · positioning brief

What you say, to whom, why.

02 · four motions

How you acquire.

03 · beachhead

Which segment first.

04 · first 100

B2B & B2C.

05 · channels

Which 2–3 of 16.

06 · funnel math

CAC, LTV, payback.

07 · team & moats

Who, what lasts.

Dashboard

Ten numbers.

One thing holding this together

Retention before acquisition, every time.

Positioning, motion, beachhead, channels, math, team, moats - every framework obeys that one rule. When in doubt, return to it.

Group allocation

Group Number	Your Channel	What is it?
1	Warm Outreach	Personal network — friends, ex-colleagues, LinkedIn 1st-degree. Day-1, zero-cost, doesn't scale.
2	Cold Outbound — Email & LinkedIn	Written, unsolicited outreach to strangers at scale. Needs a sharp hook and a list.
3	Outbound Sales — Calling & SDR Prospecting	Live, voice-based prospecting by a dedicated rep. High-touch, used for high-ACV B2B.
4	Content Marketing	Blogs, videos, guides, podcasts you create to earn trust and inbound interest. Slow compounding.
5	SEO (Organic Search)	Technical + keyword work so Google ranks you for what buyers search. 6–12 month payoff.
6	Paid Social (Meta/Instagram/TikTok)	Interruptive ads in a consumer feed. Fast, scalable, gets expensive as audiences saturate.
7	LinkedIn Ads	Paid ads targeting job title/company/seniority. The B2B-specific version of paid social.
8	Google Search Ads (SEM)	Paying to appear above organic results for high-intent search terms.
9	Email Marketing / Newsletter	Owned list you nurture over time. Cheap, high-ROI, but you have to build the list first.
10	WhatsApp / Messaging Marketing	Broadcast lists, business catalogs, order updates — India's default owned-audience channel.

Group Number	Your Channel	What is it?
11	Community Seeding	Genuinely helpful presence in Reddit/Discord/niche forums/WhatsApp groups where your buyer already hangs out.
12	Influencer / Creator Marketing	Paying or gifting creators to feature you to their audience.
13	Events & Field Marketing	Conferences, meetups, roundtables, booths — in-person relationship building.
14	Partnerships & Channel Sales	Other companies (resellers, integration partners, co-marketers) sell or promote you to their base.
15	PR & Earned Media	Getting journalists/publications to cover you unpaid. Credibility, not control.
16	Referral Programme	Incentivizing existing customers to bring in people they know.
17	Affiliate Marketing	Paying external bloggers/sites a commission per conversion they drive — different from referral (your own customers) because affiliates are professional promoters with no prior relationship to you.
18	App Store Optimization (ASO)	Optimizing your app store listing (title, screenshots, keywords, reviews) to win organic app-store search.
19	Marketplace / Aggregator Listings	Getting discovered inside someone else's platform — G2/Capterra for B2B SaaS, Amazon/Flipkart/Blinkit for products.
20	Product-Led Growth & Viral Loops	In-product mechanics (invite a friend, shareable output, collaboration) that make usage itself the acquisition engine.

Academic Groups - Section A

	Assignment Group 1	Assignment Group 2	Assignment Group 3
Names	Joy Mukhopadhyay Shreyas Suresh Vedant Yadav Roshni Rawtani Sai Amitha Gurre Om Sohani	krish hemani Deepak Jain Abhigna Argonda Akshat Gurnani Piyush Sisondia	Nirali Desai Aritra Mukherjee Raghav Gombar Dhruv Chandan Hrishita Vijaywargi

	Assignment Group 4	Assignment Group 5	Assignment Group 6
Names	Milind M Mahek Gupta Radhika Puranik Siddhant Maheshwari Utkarsh Bijraniya	Manasvini Pant Juily More Dasari Varshith Reddy Siddhant Bassi Sumit Tripathi	Saisiddharth Nandhakumar Siddharth Pandya Namratha Reddy Anirudha Aiyer Ananta Khandelwal

	Assignment Group 7	Assignment Group 8	Assignment Group 9
Names	Prerna Arora Kamil Zada Anshu Tolasaria Dhivya Vidyadharan Shrikar Mahajankatti	Palak Jain Jeet Doshi Rashmi Kularia Mikhail Philip Karan V Kulkarni	Shashank Jani Vineeth J Purvik Tulsiyan Shreya Malu Roshi Bansal

	Assignment Group 10	Assignment Group 11	Assignment Group 12
Names	Srishiv Patro Kanay Narang Durgesh Panchal Sakshi Chugh Divya Bharti	Jigyasa Bhardwaj Sathish Babu Ritika Kumari Ayush Sarkar Arsh Dube	Abhishek yadav Sayan Das Aastha Pandey Chaitra Apte Nawaz Alam

	Assignment Group 13	Assignment Group 14	Assignment Group 15
Names	Asmi Jain Kanika Mittal Ravi Bussareddy Pulkit Nigam Kshitij Khurana	Semaltika Chhabra Srish Kulkarni Aditya Harsh Lopamudra Bareja Ayush Sharma	Kesar Doshi Shreyas Kulkarni Nakshatram Sandeep Anudeep Tatireddy Raghav Mittal

	Assignment Group 16
Names	Tejaswini Chigurupati Nanthakumar R Saahil Bathija Bhushan Gaikwad Chirag Golechha

	Academic Groups - Section B		
	Assignment Group 1	**Assignment Group 2**	**Assignment Group 3**
Names	Karan Menon Abhiram Upadhyayula Aaditaa Vashisht Snehal Bandi Parth Chitkara	Ichha Jain Sanjana Pundir Vikram Aditya N Vedanth Mudholkar Shloka Mehta	Honey Gupta Samyak Pandey Anusha Karwa Anant Jain Alankrati Shinde
	Assignment Group 4	**Assignment Group 5**	**Assignment Group 6**
Names	Anushree Rahul Laddhad Vyom Bhatnagar Rahul Patil Devansh Sheth Vishweshwar Gupta Komaravelli	Aryan Wadhwa Harsha Vardan Harikrishnan D Nupur Gulgulia Manaswini Chandrasekhar	Yashvi Gada Antara Pusalkar Souvik Pati Aadit Jain Adarsh Raj
	Assignment Group 7	**Assignment Group 8**	**Assignment Group 9**
Names	Akshit Dandu Harshit Sinha Adwaith Ayella Deeva Soni Pratiksha Kudtarkar	Radhika Narayan Yash Sankhla Samkit Mehta Adit Ajay Shah Anshull Mishra	Prithvi Patil Adarsh Kulkarni Sushmitha Sarlana John Ilango Pranuthi
	Assignment Group 10	**Assignment Group 11**	**Assignment Group 12**
Names	Rajshree Mohta Shaik Roshan Sagar Choudhary Sneha Iyer Divyatej Singh	Vasudeva Kashyap Lahari Kadimicherla Shivam Srivastava Vrinda Gupta Ananthnath Togari	Sera Shah Aayush Topiwala Ashish Bajaj Swapnil Bhatt Vansh Manglani
	Assignment Group 13	**Assignment Group 14**	**Assignment Group 15**
Names	Anmay surie Saloni Patel Agnesh M P Gauaraangi Chopra Gaurav Kumar	Hasmitha Rangaswamy Manav Jain Varun Agarwal Ishaan Panchal Amlan Mahapatra	Manav Mehta Samyak Shrimal Sreelakshmi Anilkumar Aman Pandey Garima Khurana
	Assignment Group 16		
Names	Helena Maria James Sharan Raj Vepamaninti Vaibhav Tiwari Piyush Agrawal Bhavesh Jain		

Your company

SaveRound: a fintech app that rounds up every UPI payment to the nearest ₹10 and auto-invests the spare change into digital gold or a mutual fund.

Target user: 22–28 year-olds, first 1–3 years of salary, tier-1 and tier-2 Indian cities.

The Process

10 mins: discuss among yourselves on how would you use your assigned channel to increase sales for SaveRound

1 minute each: Talk to the class about your strategy.

Channel: ___
Who exactly you would target: ___ (not "young people" - a specific, named segment)
Top one or two tactic you would actually run: ___ (a real post, a real email subject line, a real partnership - not "we'd do content")
How would you know it's working in 30 days: ___ (one metric)

The Debrief

"Which 3 channels would you tell SaveRound to start with on Day 1, and which 3 would you tell them to ignore for the first 6 months? Why?" - use ICE scoring / Channel Prioritization framework.

"Which group found the most creative angle for a channel that doesn't obviously fit - Outbound Sales, Events, LinkedIn Ads?"

"If SaveRound could only afford ONE channel, which would the room vote for?"